Kaitlyn Phillips

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Education

Northern Arizona University | Flagstaff, AZ *Expected Graduation: Dec 2026*
B.S. Mechanical Engineering

Technical Projects

Ponderosa High School Off-Grid Renewable Energy System | Financial Manager / Design Team Member *Jan 2026 - Dec 2026*

- Evaluated and improved a 24-V off-grid greenhouse system integrating photovoltaic generation, a small wind turbine, battery storage, charge controllers, inverter equipment, and greenhouse loads.
- Performed wind-energy and human-powered generator analyses using MATLAB, including wind power, Weibull distribution, tip-speed ratio, voltage vs. RPM, efficiency vs. RPM, gearing, and bearing-life calculations.
- Supported design validation through FMEA, testing plans, electrical-system modeling, and evaluation of four new 120-V receptacles and a switched lighting circuit.
- Managed project budgeting, purchasing, and fundraising; coordinated cost tracking for batteries, solar, bicycle-generator, electrical, and educational components.

Human-Powered Bicycle Generator | Alternator & Electrical Analysis *2026*

- Modeled generator RPM from rider cadence and drive ratio to evaluate voltage output and identify practical operating ranges for a human-powered energy generator.
- Analyzed conversion efficiency, mechanical wear, and bearing L10 life to balance electrical output with durability and maintenance requirements.
- Contributed to component selection, electrical integration, interactive educational display planning, and second-semester validation procedures.

Professional Experience

Financial Oversight Analyst, Sr. - CEFNS | Northern Arizona University *Jun 2024 - Present*

- Lead financial oversight for state, local, grant, and foundation accounts, including budgeting, forecasting, reconciliations, variance analysis, and fiscal year-end projections.
- Manage grants, subawards, cost shares, restricted funds, payroll funding, purchasing, PCard, travel, and reimbursements while supporting University and sponsor compliance.
- Develop tracking tools, process documentation, and leadership reporting that translate complex financial data into actionable planning decisions.

Purchasing Manager - Contracts, Purchasing, and Risk Management | Northern Arizona University *Sep 2022 - Jun 2024*

- Provided University-wide procurement, contract, and risk-management oversight in accordance with University, ABOR, State, and Federal requirements.
- Supervised and trained staff, managed high-volume procurement workflows, and partnered with leadership on procurement strategy, resources, and institutional priorities.
- Developed and delivered training for PCard, ServiceNow, Purchasing, Accounts Payable, and Federal purchasing processes.

Senior Buyer - Contracts, Purchasing, and Risk Management | Northern Arizona University *Nov 2020 - Sep 2022*

- Managed high-value and time-sensitive procurements, technical RFPs, purchase orders, contracts, and specialized vendor relationships.
- Supported University-wide compliance, policy interpretation, staff training, and procurement workflows using PeopleSoft Financials and ServiceNow.

Program Coordinator - Procurement Compliance / PCard Administrator | Northern Arizona University *Apr 2018 - Nov 2020*

- Administered more than 1,000 University purchasing cards and oversaw transaction integrity, policy compliance, audit readiness, and financial reporting.
- Led State, Federal, and internal audit support; supervised employees and delivered University-wide purchasing and PCard training.

Technician | W. L. Gore *May 2017 – Apr 2018*

- Supported calibration and testing of a laser using precise calculations and coding and prepared technical reports and presentations of findings.

Skills

Technical: MATLAB | SOLIDWORKS | Microsoft Excel | Engineering Analysis | Renewable Energy Systems | Electrical/System Modeling
Professional: Budgeting & Forecasting | Procurement | Contract Management | Financial Analysis | Compliance | PeopleSoft Financials | ServiceNow | Staff Leadership